

How Claude Code Talks to Agentforce

A plain-English walkthrough for business audiences

The One-Minute Version

NOTE

What this is: A bridge that lets a developer (or anyone using Claude Code) ask a question in plain English — like *"Summarize the Jennifer Blake account"* — and get back a real answer from a Salesforce **Agentforce agent**, pulling live CRM data.

TIP

Why it matters: The same Agentforce agent your sales team uses inside Salesforce can now be called from **any tool that speaks MCP** — Claude Code, VS Code, a chatbot, a script, a web app. One agent, many front doors.

The Three Players

Player	Role	Think of it as...
Claude Code	Where the human types the question	The front desk
MCP Server	The translator in the middle	The concierge
Agentforce Agent	The brain that knows your Salesforce data	The specialist in the back office

The Flow, in Plain English

IMPORTANT

The whole trip takes about 2–4 seconds. Here's what happens between you hitting Enter and the answer appearing.

Step 1 — You ask a question

You type into Claude Code: *"Summarize the Jennifer Blake account using Agentforce."*

Step 2 — Claude Code picks the right tool

Claude Code has a catalog of available tools. It recognizes your question is about a Salesforce account summary and reaches for the `get_account_summary` tool.

Step 3 — The MCP Server gets the call

The MCP server (a small program running locally or in the cloud) receives the request. Its job is to translate the plain-English ask into something Salesforce understands.

Step 4 — The MCP Server logs into Salesforce

NOTE

Behind the scenes, the server uses **OAuth** — the same technology that lets you "Sign in with Google" — to prove to Salesforce it's allowed to ask questions. It gets back a short-lived access token (good for ~25 minutes, then auto-refreshed).

Step 5 — The MCP Server opens a conversation with the agent

It tells Salesforce: *"Start a new session with the Account Summary agent."* Salesforce returns a **session ID** — think of it as a conversation thread.

Step 6 — The agent gets the question

The MCP server passes your question into that session: *"Summarize the account named Jennifer Blake."*

Step 7 — Agentforce does its thing

The agent — which has been pre-configured in Salesforce with knowledge of your data model — runs its playbook:

- Looks up the account record
- Checks open opportunities
- Checks recent cases
- Gathers key contacts
- Calculates closed-won revenue
- Formats everything as readable markdown

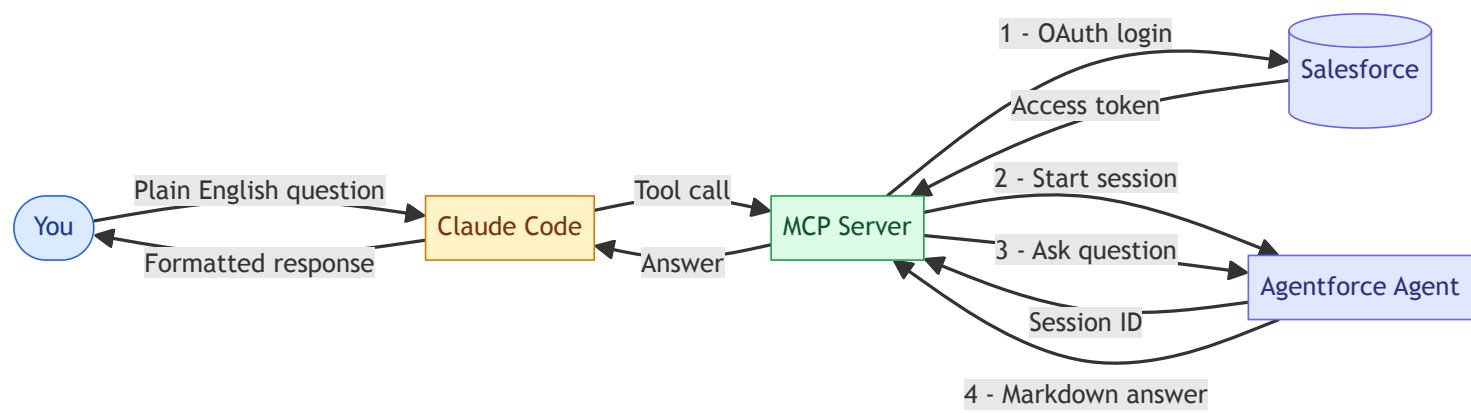
Step 8 — The answer flows back

The agent's response travels back through the MCP server to Claude Code, which displays it to you — complete with tables, headings, and bullet points.

Step 9 — Cleanup

The MCP server politely closes the session so Salesforce doesn't hold resources open.

The Picture



Legend

- Blue — the human
- Yellow — Claude Code (the front door)
- Green — the MCP server (the translator)
- Indigo — Salesforce & the Agentforce agent (the brain)

What the Business User Sees

TIP

A clean, formatted answer like this:

```
# Account Summary: Jennifer Blake

## Company Info
- Phone: (312) 555-1212
- Billing Location: Chicago, United States

## Top Open Opportunity
| Name | Stage | Amount | Close
Date |
|-----|-----|-----|-----
| Managed Portfolio Proposal for Jennifer Blake | Qualification | $72,000 | 2026-10-03 |

## Recent Cases (last 90 days)
- Total: 1 (Working: 1)

## Key Contacts
- Jennifer Blake – jblake1234@example.com
```

No SQL. No clicking through tabs. No training on where to find the data.

Why This Is a Big Deal

IMPORTANT

One agent. Many channels. The same Agentforce agent that answers inside Salesforce can now answer inside developer tools, chat clients, portals, mobile apps — anywhere MCP is supported.

TIP
Reuse, don't rebuild. Instead of building a new integration for every tool that wants Salesforce data, you build the agent once and expose it via MCP.

NOTE
Governance stays in Salesforce. The agent's permissions, data access, and guardrails are configured in Salesforce — not in the client. Change them once, every channel inherits the change.

Security at a Glance

CAUTION
This matters for IT review.

Concern	How it's handled
Who can call the MCP server?	Optional bearer-token authentication; recommended when the server is exposed over the internet.
How does the server talk to Salesforce?	OAuth 2.0 Client Credentials flow with a Connected App — no passwords, no long-lived keys in code.
What user does the agent run as?	A configured "Run-As" user on the Connected App — their permission set controls what the agent can see.
Where do credentials live?	In a local <code>.env</code> file, never committed to source control.
Does the agent see more than it should?	No — it inherits the Run-As user's data visibility (sharing rules, FLS, record access).

What Changes for the Business

Before	After
Rep opens Salesforce, clicks through 3 tabs	Rep asks in natural language, gets a summary in 3 seconds
Dev builds a new integration per channel	Dev builds the agent once, every channel plugs in
Each new tool needs a security review	One MCP server, one review, many consumers

Common Questions

NOTE

"Is my data leaving Salesforce?"

Only the agent's final answer leaves — and only to the client that asked. Salesforce's data stays in Salesforce.

NOTE

"What if the agent is wrong?"

The agent is grounded in your CRM — it answers from real records, not from a language model's memory. If a record is wrong in Salesforce, the agent reflects that; fix the record and the agent updates immediately.

NOTE

"How do we add a new capability?"

Add a new topic or action to the agent in Agentforce Studio. The MCP server doesn't need code changes — it just forwards whatever question comes in.

WARNING

"What's the catch?"

The agent only knows what you've taught it. If you ask it something outside its topics (e.g. HR questions when it's an account-summary agent), it will politely decline. That's a feature, not a bug.

In One Sentence

TIP

Agentforce + MCP = your Salesforce agents become available anywhere a developer or user already works, with security and governance intact.